Hello, my name is Janis Rancourt and I am a NYC-based, neurodivergent, self-taught software engineer with 20 years of coding experience. In lieu of a traditional cover letter, I'd like to attach below a testimonial from my former employer below:

Hello,

I am writing in support of Janis Rancourt, a former employee, whom you would benefit from interviewing for the job she has applied for. Please read on.

I had the pleasure of having Janis Rancourt work with us at Ultranauts for a three year period spanning 2020 through 2023. Our company, which provides software quality assurance, software test automation, and data quality services has had several rounds of business climate-related layoffs over the past two years, similar to many software consulting services firms. Janis was in our third round of layoffs, and had business been better for us, she would likely still be employed with us. Important points to consider about Janis that you can't find on a resume:

- Janis is technically proficient and talented, despite not having a technical college degree. Her years of self-training and training on the job has provided knowledge she needed to perform well.

- At the time of her layoff, which was entirely due to business conditions (her project ended and we did not have a new project for Janis and several of her colleagues), Janis was slated to be promoted to Senior Quality Engineer. Due to business conditions, we had to suspend promotions after the decision to promote her was made.

- Our fully remote workplace was helpful for Janis, given her physical disabilities, which pose a significant challenge for commuting. These disabilities did not impact her work as a remote Quality Engineer.

- Ultranauts in its ten year existence has focused our hiring on neurodivergent people, and this resulted in a workforce in which autistic people accounted for 70% of our staff, including Janis. During this time, we have demonstrated that a neurodivergent workforce is a significant advantage. Janis has a strong ability to focus intensely on whichever problem she is trying to solve, and this trait combined with her technical skills and tenacity, have been very beneficial to our clients.

I have been working in software (design, development, testing, quality assurance, technical management, executive management) for over 30 years and I was glad that we had hired Janis. I have conducted hundreds of interviews during my career, including over 100 for Ultranauts, and hiring Janis was an easy decision. She is a stellar example of a strong producer without having a college degree.

Her manager provided this information in support of Janis' promotion:

"*After joining the team and learning about the basic testing happening on the account Janis was assigned to the mobile testing workstream. This workstream is tasked with testing the mobile instance of the client's interfaces. The testing was performed by the client in a manual form and the goal was for Ultranauts to create a stable, scalable automation solution that could be inserted into the client CI/CD pipeline. After a brief period as a contributor in the space, Janis has taken over the mobile space with a vision to both finish the work that was started, fill the gaps in the work that was preventing completion, refactoring the code to make it more stable, cleaning up the documentation and being a champion for clean coding and crisp, meaningful and current documentation. Janis has been a continued advocate for a holistic view of assets defined by understanding how assets fit together to enable evaluation of client workflows. She took over the mobile area with substantial open issues regarding gaps in code, incomplete solutions, poor documentation, and lots of assets that needed manual interventions and monitoring. In the time she has had it* ***she has resolved all of the issues almost single-handedly*** *(from a design, solution and in many instances coding perspective) and we were able to hand over the mobile automation assets to the client and they have successfully added them into their CI/CD process (confirmed by client in our weekly meeting). Janis' work in the space has helped clarify how to resource it so that it functions better. This has opened the conversation again on team load balancing by allowing the Quality Manager and I to adjust the interaction of the workstreams to provide support that advances holistic coverage goals-which also was leveraged by Janis to accomplish the items listed above.*"

Please contact me for further information if that will help.

Thank you,
-Brian
Brian King | Senior Vice President, Operations | Ultranauts
2578 Broadway, Suite 602 | New York, NY 10025 | USA
m: 732.740.7968 | brian@ultranauts.co

Janis Rancourt
New York, NY | janis.rancourt@gmail.com | (347) 677-3964 | https://yaycupcake.dev/
https://github.com/yaycupcake | https://www.linkedin.com/in/janis-rancourt/

Highly skilled & motivated Software Engineer with 20 years of technical experience, specializing in scalable and Mobile and Web Development & Software Test Automation. Proficient in web languages & testing frameworks. Proven experience in problem solving, holistic thinking, team leadership, community management, & user-centric solutions.

Key Skills

Languages: Fluent in English, Conversational in Japanese
Tech Stack: CSS (SASS/SCSS, Tailwind, Bootstrap, CSS-in-JS), JavaScript (Node.js, React, React Native, Svelte, TypeScript, jQuery), Python, Java, Ruby on Rails, PHP, R, C++, MediaWiki, git
Programs: Advanced Microsoft Excel & Google Sheets, Slack, Adobe Suite (Photoshop, InDesign, Illustrator, XD), Figma, Jira, Confluence, Testrail
STA: Selenium, Jest, Cypress, Appium, Playwright
Databases: SQL (MySQL, SQLite, PostgreSQL), NoSQL (MongoDB, Amazon DynamoDB)

Experience

Software Engineer *CompatibilityAI* *3/2025-Present*

- Improved UI performance by addressing layout issues on the front end using React Native for more robust functionality.
- Handled comprehensive manual testing and bug reports, as well as fixing those bugs, leading to enhanced stability in production grade code.
- Collaborated on *Twine* app in a small startup environment, using combined background in software development, software testing and automation, accessibility advocacy, graphic design, and social media expertise, to help bring new app features to life, and improve user experience.

Senior Quality Engineer *Ultranauts Inc* *9/2020-7/2023*

- Developed and implemented hundreds of automated, end-to-end tests for web and mobile app UIs and APIs as a technical lead and subject matter expert
- Architected scalable and maintainable codebases across three client projects, utilizing best practices in code development and architecture, git and versioning, and agile methodology.
- Collaborated with 50+ clients from companies including Colgate-Palmolive, NBC, GoodLeap, Comcast, Nayya, and Slack, providing technical guidance to a team of 30+ members.

Digital Experience Specialist *Freelancer* 7/2011-Present

Site Administration

- Designed and deployed online resources, prioritizing accessibility and responsive design, utilizing best practices in modern CSS, semantic HTML, and efficient JavaScript.
- Built and maintained SQL databases and PHP configuration files.
- Ensured seamless server operation through timely software updates and routine backups.
- Led a team of content editors to create the #1 most relied upon resource in the community.

Online Community Management - Administrator and Moderator

- Automated repetitive tasks and guided communities with over 150,000 active members.
- Proactively addressed feedback and orchestrated large-scale events.

User Script Creation- Specializing in deploying JavaScript and CSS Development

- Crafted JavaScript and CSS code to elevate accessibility and enhance UX across numerous websites.
- Published the code publicly, contributing to the community's benefit.

Web Developer, Translator, & Planner *Team FE for Extra Life Charity Events* *2017-2020*

- Built and maintained a scheduling website for charity events.
- Coordinated bilingual outreach with Japanese-speaking community and assisted in planning events that raised over $30,000.

Software Engineering Fellow *General Assembly* 3/2020-6/2020

- Developed full-stack applications, participated in pair programming, and mentored peers.
- Utilized efficient algorithms to deliver high-performing solutions.

Education

General Assembly **Software Engineering**
Japan Society Language Center **Japanese Language**
SUNY Fashion Institute of Technology **Graphic Design**

Awards

General Assembly x Octagon Hackathon Winner *1st place out of 8 teams.* 2020

- Conducted research, designed, and prototyped a concept for a mobile payments app within one week.
- Developed a working tech demo to showcase the idea.